Mirror World — Design Update v3

Oct 24, 2026 · @Aryendra Pratap Singh

v3 fixes 10 problems found in design v2, and adds a handoffs table: who waits for whom, and when. Attach this doc to Claude **together with the Claude Playbook**. Where they differ, **this doc wins**.

How to use this update

Teammates:

1. Export this doc and the **Claude Playbook** as Markdown or PDF.
2. **Haven't started yet?** Attach both to a new Claude chat and say "I'm Person A" (or B or C) "and the jam is at 0:00".
3. **Already started?** In your current chat, attach this doc and say: "Apply the v3 update. Here are my current files." Then attach or paste your files.

Instructions for Claude:

- This update changes design v2 and the Claude Playbook. **Wherever they differ, follow this doc.** Everything not mentioned here stays as the playbook says.
- First, read **What changed** and the section for this person. Tell them in 3–5 short lines what changes for them.
- If they've already built files, update those files to match the new contracts before continuing with the next step. Give complete files, as always.
- If a change needs something in a teammate's file, write them a short message to send instead of editing it.
- Check new level designs with the **replay check** in `rules-test.html` (fix 7), not by counting moves in your head.

Handoffs (Claude): at the end of every step, check **Handoffs** below. If this person owes a teammate a message now, write it for them to send. If they're waiting on one, keep them busy with the next task that doesn't need it, and never let them sit idle.

What changed

The rules the player learns, the story and the three endings are the same. What changes is how levels are written, which levels we build, and a few safety nets.

#	Problem in v2	Fix in v3	Affects
1	Story events were timed by move count, so they fired in the wrong place when players wandered, undid or bumped walls. A required disobey could make a level impossible	In Acts 1–2, events fire when a character **steps on a marked tile**. Act 3 keeps move counts (Sam's route is fixed)	A, B
2	Level 7 taught Look and tricked players with it in the same level; Mercy could only reach 1	Build **Level 6 instead of Level 3**. Level 6 teaches Look; Level 7 then asks you to let one disobey happen. **Boxes are cut**	A, B, C
3	Level 12 endings could happen by accident: Stay Behind by just pressing Space, Take Their Place by spending a 5th Will unknowingly	At 4 cracks the glass **strains** and shows ONE MORE. One turn before Sam leaves, a hint says **Sam is about to leave…**	A, B, C
4	Levels 9–11 had no story reason for the goal tile	The goal is where Theo **writes a message** to Sam. Reaching it leaves the message, building toward the attic	A, B
5	The true ending needs Sam to choose, but Sam's notes were first to be cut	Sam's note **IS SOMEONE THERE?** opens Level 12 and is now a must-have	A, B
6	Level 8 showed TOGETHER before the smash, so players tried to cooperate and couldn't	TOGETHER now appears **during the smash**, in the swap scene, when it's already too late	A, B
7	Claude checking puzzles in its head is unreliable	`rules-test.html` gets a **replay check**: every level stores its solution, and one button plays them all through the real rules	A, B
8	Levels filled only a small part of the 960×540 screen	Everything is drawn at **2×** (64 px per tile on screen). Maps are at most **7 tiles wide per side and 6 tall**	A, B, C

#	Problem in v2	Fix in v3	Affects
9	Pressing Undo right after winning could undo the win while the next level loads	After a win, the rules ignore every input; after a fail, only RESTART works. B locks keys during transitions	A, B
10	"The glass is whole" was unclear	Say **unbroken**: fewer than 5 cracks. The rules themselves don't change	Everyone

Playbook lines this update replaces

Claude: ignore these lines in the playbook and use the v3 version instead.

The playbook says	Use instead
Team table: A owns `level05` – `level12`, B owns `level01` – `level04`	A owns `level05` and `level07` – `level12`. B owns `level01`, `level02`, `level04` and `level06`. `level03` stays empty
Game in short: we build 1, 2, 3, 5, 7, 8, 9, 12; Look and the shimmer unlock in Level 7; Mercy is 0–1	We build 1, 2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 12; Look and the shimmer unlock in Level 6; Mercy is 0–2
Level format: events use `turn`	Acts 1–2 use `at` (a tile or `"start"`); Act 3 keeps `turn`
Map symbol `x`, the `boxes` field, the `push` event	Boxes are cut
"Tiles are 32×32 pixels"	Files are 32×32, drawn at 2× (64 px) on screen; the mirror strip is 32 px
Maps 7–9 tiles wide per side, 5–7 tall (A5, B3)	At most 7 wide per side and 6 tall
Level 1 example without a `solution`	The v3 Level 1 example
A2: after `won` or `failed`, only UNDO and RESTART work	After `won`, nothing works; after `failed`, only RESTART
A3: boxes	No boxes
B3: "A's plates and boxes land around 1:45"	Plates, doors and spikes land around 1:30

The playbook says	Use instead
A8: TOGETHER as a text event in Level 8	No TOGETHER event in Level 8; B shows it in the swap scene
B3: Level 3, Bedroom	Cut
B4: the Act 3 strip, footprints and eye icon	Moved to B6. B4 is Level 6 plus the text and hint display
B11: write the game description at 7:30–8:00	Write it at 5:15 and send it to C by 5:30
A12 and B11: final push at 7:30–8:00	Final push **by 7:30 sharp**
C4: `box.png`	Not needed
Effects: the list of `onMoment` types	Add `"strain"`
Story text: the list of `STORY` fields	Add `together`
"If we fall behind"	The updated cut list at the end of this doc

The new 8 levels

We build **1, 2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 12**. Level 3 (boxes) is cut and Level 6 takes its place. B now designs Level 6, so B and A share the levels more evenly.

#	Room	Owner	Teaches	Story beat	Cracks after
1	Hallway	B	Moving, the mirror rule, walls line the two up	The reflection blinks as the level opens	0
2	Bathroom	B	A plate on one side opens a door on the other	I'M SORRY on the misty glass	0
5	Kitchen	A	Lag 2; the one Undo lock	IT REMEMBERS and LET ME OUT; one unwarned, required disobey makes the first crack	1
6	Cellar	B	Look unlocks. One warned, stoppable disobey: the Look lesson	The reflection waves; Theo's colour starts to fade	1–2

#	Room	Owner	Teaches	Story beat	Cracks after
7	Library	A	Two warned disobeys: stop the first, **let the second happen** (the only way to reach a plate). The reflection tilts toward that plate first, as a clue	A short slip; IT HAS TO BE SOMEONE; "Maybe let it." after a restart	2–4
8	Attic	A	Everything at once; both goals beside the mirror; no disobeys	TOGETHER appears during the smash; the swap	Breaks, then 0
9	Kitchen, years later	A	Follow, Resist, Break; 2 Will; the control card	Theo's message COME UPSTAIRS reaches Sam	Heals to 0
12	Attic, years later	A	The final choice; 5 Will	Sam's note IS SOMEONE THERE?; ONE MORE at 4 cracks; "Sam is about to leave…"	Decides the ending

- **Mercy** can now reach 2 (one stoppable disobey each in Levels 6 and 7), so Mara's nod in the true ending is reachable.
- **File owners:** B owns `level01`, `level02`, `level04` and `level06`. A owns `level05` and `level07` – `level12`. `level03.js` stays empty.
- **Only if we're ahead:** Level 4 (swap tiles), Level 10 and Level 11. With all of Act 3 built, Theo's messages become I'M HERE (9), DON'T BE AFRAID (10) and COME UPSTAIRS (11).

Handoffs: who waits for whom

Everyone works in parallel. These are the only moments one person hands something to another. **Push first, then send the message in the team chat.** If a handoff is late, the receiver keeps working on the "If it's late" task and never sits idle. If it's more than 20 minutes late, tell the team and use the cut list.

Time	From → to	Message to send	Receiver then	If it's late
0:10	B → A, C	"Starter files pushed. Pull now."	Clone or pull, start step 2	Keep installing and reading the contracts; C keeps drawing

Time	From → to	Message to send	Receiver then	If it's late
0:20	B → A, C	"Live link: (link)"	Bookmark it	Test with Live Server on your laptop
1:00	A → B	"Real rules pushed: movement, mirror, undo."	Pull; the game now runs on the real rules	Keep using the stand-in
1:30	A → B	"Plates, doors and spikes in. Replay check works."	Test Levels 1–2 with **Check all levels**	Keep building the title and story screens
1:30	B → C	"The game calls the Effects functions now."	Pull to see your effects in the real game (optional)	Keep testing on `effects-test.html`
2:30	A → B	"Tile triggers, Look and disobeys in."	Test Level 6	Build the text and hint display first
3:00	Everyone	Check-in	Pull, play the live link for 15 minutes, send each owner a bug list	—
4:30	A → B	"Act 3 rules in."	Swap the HUD test keys for real values	Keep using the test keys
5:00	A → B	"Levels 8 and 9 pushed."	Test the swap scene and control card for real	Keep using the test keys
5:00	Everyone	Check-in	Same as 3:00	—
5:30	B → C	The game description: one-line pitch, how to play, keys, how it uses "reversal", team names	Put it on the submission page	Use placeholder text and swap it in later
6:00	C → B	"`title.png` pushed."	Nothing: the title screen picks it up by itself	The text title stays
6:15	A → everyone	"Level 12 passes" or "Using the Level 12 safety net"	B tests the endings for real	B keeps the test keys

Time	From → to	Message to send	Receiver then	If it's late
6:30	Everyone	Feature freeze	Only bug fixes from now on	—
7:30	A and B → C	"Final push done." (**hard deadline**)	C pulls, zips and uploads	C waits at most 10 minutes, then zips what's pushed
8:00	C → everyone	"Submitted: (link)"	—	—

Bug lists: after each check-in, and from 6:30, send each bug to the person who owns that file. Only the owner fixes it.

Contract changes

These replace the matching parts of the playbook's **Shared contracts**. Everything else there stays the same.

Level format

Events in Acts 1–2 use `at` instead of `turn`:

- `at: "start"` fires as the level opens.
- `at: { who: "person" or "reflection", x, y }` fires the first time that character stands on that tile, right after its move. `x, y` are in that character's half.
- Each event fires at most once per attempt. RESTART resets them. UNDO back past the move that fired one un-fires it, so it fires again if the character returns.
- **Act 3** events keep `turn: N` (Sam's route makes timing reliable). `at: "start"` works there too.

Disobey timing: when a `disobey` is triggered and has `warn: true`, the rules send a `moment` of kind `"shimmer"` straight away. On the **next move**, the reflection moves `dir` instead of mirroring, unless Theo uses Look on that move. With `warn: false` (Level 5 only), the timing is the same but there's no shimmer. `kind` (`"stoppable"` or `"required"`) works as before.

New fields:

Field	Where	Meaning
`solution`	Every level except 12	The inputs that solve it, separated by spaces, using the input names: `"R R R R"` or `"L LOOK R"`
`solutions`	Level 12	One per ending: `{ take: "...", break: "...", stay: "..." }`
`message`	Act 3 Levels 9–11	Theo's words when he reaches his goal

Removed: boxes (`x`). **Map size:** at most **7 tiles wide per side and 6 tall**. **Level 8:** no TOGETHER event any more; B shows it in the swap scene.

Level 1 in v3:

```
LEVELS.push({
  number: 1, name: "Hallway", act: 1,
  map: [
    "#######|#######",
    "#T...G#|#G..R.#",
    "#######|#######"
  ],
  events: [ { at: "start", do: "blink" } ],
  solution: "R R R R"
});
```

A tile-triggered disobey:

```
{ at: { who: "reflection", x: 3, y: 2 }, do: "disobey", dir: "U", kind:
"stoppable", warn: true }
```

Rules interface

- `Rules.load` also returns **`state.startEvents`** : events to play as soon as the level appears (from `at: "start"`). Same shapes as the events `step` returns.
- After `status: "won"` , `step` ignores **every** input. After `"failed"` , only `RESTART` works.
- `boxes` stays in the state but is always empty; the `push` event is no longer used.
- New `moment` kind: **`"strain"`** .

- **Act 3 Levels 9–11:** when Theo wins, before `win`, send two `text` events with the level's `message`: first on the right, not mirrored (Theo writing it), then on the left, mirrored (how Sam sees it).
- **Level 12 additions:**
  - Sam's note opens the level: `{ at: "start", do: "text", words: "IS SOMEONE THERE?", side: "left", mirrored: true }`.
  - When cracks reach 4: `text` ONE MORE (right side, mirrored) and a `moment` of kind `"strain"`.
  - One turn before `samRoute` ends: `hint` "Sam is about to leave…"
  - The five ending checks are unchanged.

Drawing

- Image files stay 32×32, but everything is drawn at **2× on screen** (64 px per tile), by scaling the sprites rather than zooming the camera, so screen positions stay simple.
- The mirror strip is 32 px wide on screen. The level is centred in the 960×540 game, with the top and bottom bars outside it.
- `scene.mirror` is still `{x, top, bottom}` in screen positions.

Effects

- `Effects.onMoment` gets a new type, **`"strain"`**: the cracks glow brighter, a soft low hum plays and the music dips. Gentle, never scary.
- `box.png` is no longer needed.

Story text

- New `STORY` field **`together`**: the word TOGETHER, shown on the mirror side during the smash.
- `act3` and `controlCard` now mention that Theo's will grows a little stronger each night (2, then 3, 4 and 5 Will).

Wording

Unbroken means fewer than 5 cracks. Rule 6 now reads: the mirror is destroyed only if both sides touch its frame at the same moment, by choice, while the glass is unbroken.

Changes for Person A — Logic

Boxes are gone, which frees about 30 minutes. That time goes into tile triggers and the replay check. Steps not listed stay as the playbook says.

Step	Time	What changes
A2	0:20–1:00	Add `state.startEvents` (empty for now). After `won`, ignore every input; after `failed`, only RESTART. Add the **replay check** to `rules-test.html` (below)
A3	1:00–1:30	Plates, doors and spikes only. **No boxes**
A4	1:30–2:30	Events in Acts 1–2 fire from **tile triggers** (`at`), plus `at: "start"`. Warned disobeys: shimmer when triggered, disobey on the next move. UNDO un-fires triggers. Everything else in A4 stays
A5	2:30–3:00	Levels 5 and 7 with tile triggers and a `solution` each. In Level 7, put a `tilt` moment just before the required disobey, so the reflection seems to point at the plate. Answer B's rule questions about Level 6
A7	3:15–4:30	Act 3 events keep `turn`. When Theo wins Levels 9–11, send the two `message` texts before `win`
A8	4:30–5:00	**Level 8:** no TOGETHER event. **Level 9:** `message: "COME UPSTAIRS"`. Both get a `solution`
A10	5:15–6:30	**Level 12** also gets: Sam's note at the start; ONE MORE plus a `strain` moment when cracks reach 4; the hint "Sam is about to leave…" one turn before the route ends; `solutions` for all three endings

The replay check (add in A2, grow it as you go)

Add to `rules-test.html`:

- **A replay box:** paste inputs like `R R LOOK L`, press **Replay**. It restarts the level, plays each input through `Rules.step`, lists what happened at every step, and shows the final status, cracks, Mercy and ending.
- **Check all levels:** plays every level's `solution` and shows pass or fail for each. A level passes when it ends `won`. For Level 12, each of `take`, `break` and `stay` must reach its own ending.
- **Check Act 2 chain:** plays Levels 5, 6, 7 and 8 in order, passing `carry` along, and fails if cracks ever reach 5 before Level 8's smash.

Rules for building levels (A and B)

- Use tile triggers in Acts 1–2. Place story moments at the start or end of a level, never in the middle of the hard part.
- Maps are at most 7 tiles wide per side and 6 tall.
- Every level has a `solution` that passes **Check all levels** before you push it.
- Run **Check Act 2 chain** after any change to Levels 5–8.

New done-when for A10: Check all levels and Check Act 2 chain both pass.

Your handoffs (A)

- **You wait for:** B's starter files at about 0:10. Nothing else.
- **You send B:** "Real rules pushed" (1:00, end of A2) · "Plates, doors and spikes in" (1:30, end of A3) · "Tile triggers, Look and disobeys in" (2:30, end of A4) · "Act 3 rules in" (4:30, end of A7) · "Levels 8 and 9 pushed" (5:00, end of A8).
- **You send everyone:** "Level 12 passes" or "Using the Level 12 safety net" (6:15).
- **Final push by 7:30 sharp**, then tell C "Final push done". After that, play the live link and report anything wrong; don't push again unless C asks.

Changes for Person B — Screens & story

Level 3 is gone and **Level 6 is now yours**. The Act 3 HUD moves later, next to the rest of the Act 3 work. Steps not listed stay as the playbook says.

Step	Time	What changes
B1	0:00–0:20	`level01.js` uses the v3 format (above). The stand-in rules return `startEvents: []` and ignore input after a win. `level03.js` stays empty. Already pushed? Update those two files now
B2	0:20–1:30	Draw everything at **2×** (64 px tiles, a 32 px mirror strip), centred. Play `state.startEvents` right after `Effects.setCracks`, the same way as step events. **Lock the keys** from the moment the status becomes `won` or `failed` until the next level or the restart has loaded. No boxes
B3	1:30–2:30	**Levels 1 and 2 only**, each with a `solution` that passes A's **Check all levels**. Title and story screens as before
B4	2:30–3:00	**Level 6, Cellar** (`act: 2`, `look: true`), plus the `text` and `hint` display. The Act 3 HUD moves to B6
B6	3:15–4:30	Adds the `together` field and the swap-scene change, plus the Act 3 HUD moved here (strip, Will, footprints with the glow, Sam's eye icon)

Level 6, Cellar (B4)

- The Look lesson. One warned, `stoppable` disobey, placed where the shimmer is easy to see and there's an obvious moment to press Space.
- The bottom bar shows "Space look" from the start of this level.
- A `wave` moment when the level opens (`at: "start"`).
- Solvable both ways: with Look, and by letting the disobey happen. The `solution` uses Look.
- At most 7 tiles wide per side and 6 tall.
- Design it first, then test on `rules-test.html` once A's tile triggers land (about 2:30). Do the `text` and `hint` display while you wait, so you're never blocked.

The swap scene (B6)

On `glassBreak`: call `Effects.onGlassBreak()` and `Effects.setCracks(0)`, and fade `STORY.together` onto the mirror side for about 2 seconds. Then the `swap` card, the `act3` card, the Level 9 control card.

Story text (B6)

- Add `together: "TOGETHER"` to `STORY`.
- `act3` and `controlCard` each say, in one line, that Theo's will grows a little stronger every night.

Level 12 warning (B6)

When a `moment` of kind `"strain"` arrives, the Will counter on the HUD turns warm `#E9B872` and pulses gently.

Your handoffs (B)

- **You wait for:** nothing. Every A milestone (1:00, 1:30, 2:30, 4:30, 5:00, 6:15) just means "pull and test this for real". Until then, use the stand-in or a temporary test key.
- **You send:** "Starter files pushed" to A and C (0:10) · the live link (0:20) · "The game calls the Effects functions now" to C (1:30, end of B2).
- **Game description:** write it in the first 15 minutes of B9 and send it to C **by 5:30** (it moves here from B11).
- **Final push by 7:30 sharp**, then tell C "Final push done".

Changes for Person C — Look & sound

Small changes. Steps not listed stay as the playbook says.

Step	Time	What changes
C2	0:20–1:00	`effects-test.html` draws at **2×** (64 px tiles, a 32 px mirror strip), like the real game. Add a **Strain** button
C4	2:00–3:00	Skip `box.png`

Step	Time	What changes
C6	3:15–4:30	Add `onMoment("strain")`: the cracks on the mirror glow brighter, a soft low hum plays, and the music dips. Gentle, never scary

Sprites at 2×: image files stay 32×32, but each pixel now shows as 2×2 on screen. Check them on the test page at that size: clean outlines and simple shapes read best.

The strain hum: play `moment.wav` slowed down and quiet, or ask Claude for a soft low tone made in code. No new sound file is needed.

Your handoffs (C)

- **You wait for:** B's starter files at about 0:10 (keep drawing meanwhile) · B's game description by 5:30 (use placeholder text until then) · A's and B's "Final push done" at 7:30.
- **You send B:** "`title.png` pushed" (6:00).
- **C11 now starts at 7:30:** once both say "Final push done" (wait at most 10 minutes), pull, zip, upload, play it once in a private window, and submit before 8:00. Then send everyone the link.

Updated cut list

This replaces the playbook's "If we fall behind" list. Cut from the top first.

Never cut: movement and the mirror rule, Level 8's swap, Act 3's Follow / Resist / Break, the crack counter, the Take Their Place and Break It Together endings, Sam's note IS SOMEONE THERE?, and the ONE MORE warning.

Order	Cut	Whose
1	"New Game — Sam" loop, Mara's nod	B
2	Music themes: one quiet loop, or none	C
3	Slip in Level 7	A
4	Mercy's TOGETHER hint in Level 12	A
5	Title art: plain text title	C

Order	Cut	Whose
6	Moments other than blink, shimmer and strain	C
7	Theo's message when he reaches the goal in Level 9	A, B
8	Sprites: coloured squares with two dots for eyes, drawn in code	C
9	Stay Behind ending (keep the NOT TONIGHT restart)	A, B
10	Level 6: Level 7's first disobey becomes the Look lesson (7 levels)	B, A

Level 12 safety net: if Level 12 isn't passing **Check all levels** by 6:15, ship it with just Take Their Place and Break It Together, and let a route that ends with any other Will amount show NOT TONIGHT and restart.